

understand what was wrong when I tried something different with my physiotherapy and started doing a lot more shoulder stabilisation," he says.

"The problem was that the scapula from my right shoulder was not in the right position. The head of the humerus doesn't rest properly in it. As a result of that, I wasn't getting my shoulder to move in the right angle and get into the right positions. That caused the constant pain. Once we figured out what was wrong, we were able to work on stabilisation," he says.

The regimen for the most part has worked. "When I started training in October, we directly began with throwing some balls and javelins. We were only throwing indoors but suddenly I felt no pain. That's when I knew that I was on the right track," he says.

Just because the injury has been diagnosed and treated doesn't mean it's all smooth roads ahead. His injury can be managed with physiotherapy but it's a recurring one. Also, according to him, he can't do a lot of shoulder stabilisation otherwise the same shoulder can become overstimulated. Vetter will have to try and find that balance if he is to throw pain-free.

Olympic dreams

With the Olympics a little over three months away, Vetter will very

much hope for that to be the case. In the trophy cabinet at his home, perhaps the biggest hole is the empty space where he had hoped to place an Olympic medal.

Back in 2021, he was the undisputed favourite for the Tokyo Games. He'd thrown over 90 metres at seven separate competitions in the lead-up to the Olympics. Then where it mattered most, Vetter struggled. He complained of not finding enough grip on the runways, slipped on his first attempt and only managed to throw 82.52m.

"I just couldn't get the right grip when I was blocking. My foot was just skidding. When that happens you can't do anything. If you are slipping on the track, there is no way you can make a good throw. That was the most difficult part of what happened at the Olympics. I had really good throws before the Olympics and I had really good throws after it (he competed in another six competitions post-Tokyo with a best throw of 89.60m and a lowest of 86.17m)," he says.

In the months after the disaster at Tokyo, Vetter has had a role to play in changing the

quality of the runway. "Mondo had created a new running surface, especially for the Olympics in Tokyo but unfortunately they made every running surface in the stadium. And that's not going to work for the javelin throw especially if you produce as much power as I did. I was coming down so hard that the surface couldn't hold me. After the Tokyo Olympics, Mondo and I tried to find a solution that worked for everyone. Now the runways at any Mondo track are a lot harder and have more grip. The change hasn't been made across the whole stadium, just the 8 metres of the runway before blocking. I've

also worked with Puma to make a shoe that gives me more grip," he says.

While he couldn't put a performance together when he most needed to, Vetter looks back at the 2021 season with

